Dictionaries in Python

BEGINNER LESSON | Qspiders | Python 3

Learning goals: Create key-value pairs, read a value, and update a value.

1. What is a dictionary?

A dictionary stores `key: value` pairs inside braces `{}`. A key is a label used to find its value. Python calls this type `dict`.

2. Create and use

Use a colon between a key and its value, and commas between pairs. Read or update a value by using its key.

```
student = {"name": "Asha", "age": 18}
print(student["name"])  # Output: Asha
student["age"] = 19
print(student["age"])   # Output: 19
```

3. Check the type

Use `type()` to find a value's data type.

```
print(type(student))  # Output: <class 'dict'>
```

4. Key points

- Keys are unique; values may repeat. Reusing a key replaces its value.
- You can add, remove, or change entries.
- Dictionaries keep the order in which entries were added.
- `{}` creates an empty dictionary.

5. Try it yourself

Create a dictionary with `"name"` and `"city"` keys. Print the city, then change its value.